

ANKIT AGARWAL

SENIOR PROJECT & PRODUCT MANAGER | BFSI, CORE BANKING, PAYMENTS & DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven **Senior Project & Product Manager** with 12+ years of experience steering end-to-end digital banking, core payment platforms, and fintech transformation initiatives across the complete SDLC. Proven track record leading multi-disciplinary cross-functional squads (15+ members spanning engineering, product, QA, risk, operations, and compliance) to deliver high-velocity, regulatory-compliant solutions across UPI, ACH, SWIFT, and Cross-Border payments. Expert in translating complex business/regulatory needs into actionable roadmaps (Aha!, Jira), shaping target operating models (TOM), and managing RAID registers. SME in operationalizing KYC/AML (CDD/EDD), PEP & Sanctions Screening, Behavioral Fraud Analytics, and Commercial Lending workflows for top-tier MNCs, Unicorns, and high-growth BFSI platforms.

5% – 8% Faster Delivery AGILE SPEED & SPRINT GOVERNANCE	8% – 10% Defect Reduction SHIFT-LEFT QA & HYPERCARE	100% / Zero Breach AML / KYC / BSA REGULATORY RECORD
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Project & Product Manager – Banking & Payments | Rugr Fintech Pvt. Ltd. Sep 2025 – Present | Mumbai, India (Hybrid)

- Direct end-to-end project and product delivery for core banking and multi-rail payment platforms (UPI, ACH, SWIFT, Cross-Border Payments), steering scope, budget, RAID risk registers, and quality gates across 15+ member cross-functional squads.
- Define product vision, strategic roadmaps (Aha!), and prioritize backlogs across 6 parallel transformation workstreams: Client Onboarding, KYC/AML Sanction Screening, Behavioral Fraud Monitoring, Credit Operations, and Chargeback Analysis.
- Translate 100+ complex regulatory and market requirements into detailed epics, user stories, process flows, and acceptance criteria in Jira, accelerating program delivery timelines firm-wide by 5–8%.
- Negotiate key vendor contracts and third-party API integration SLAs, optimizing operational margins while upholding stringent platform security, data integrity, and compliance guidelines.
- Establish Target Operating Model (TOM) frameworks and cross-functional governance across technology, legal, compliance, and operations to streamline cross-border payment initiation and settlement.

Project / Program & Product Manager | TRST Health Pvt. Ltd. Mar 2024 – Apr 2025 | Pune, India (Remote)

- Spearheaded release management and Agile governance across multi-pod engineering teams, managing full release lifecycles including production readiness, deployment governance, defect triage, and post-production hypercare.
- Slashed production defect rates by 8–10% by overhauling QA governance, introducing mandatory pre-release readiness reviews, and embedding automated quality gates in sprint planning.
- Managed cross-pod dependencies, critical path risk mitigations, and Jira backlog health, significantly enhancing delivery predictability and feature deployment lead times.
- Mentored PM, QA, BA, and operations leads, reducing senior executive escalations by ~30% through executive status reporting, Power BI MIS dashboards, and clear risk escalation protocols.

Senior QA & Project Lead – Enterprise Banking | Synechron Digital Pvt. Ltd. Aug 2021 – Feb 2024 | Pune, India

- Led end-to-end test planning, UAT execution, and delivery coordination across enterprise global banking and cross-border payment transformation programs.
- Compressed dev cycle times by 5–7% by shifting QA left into sprint planning and backlog grooming, catching requirement gaps upstream prior to code build.
- Served as primary liaison between business stakeholders, development pods, and global delivery leads to ensure seamless ISO 20022 message flows, payment gateway integrations, and production deployments.
- Contributed core delivery governance frameworks and quality assurance best practices to Synechron's Global Payments Practice.

Sr. Risk & Project Manager – Digital Lending | Commercial Capital Funding LLC Aug 2020 – Mar 2022 | Remote (US)

- Served as primary escalation point for KYC (CDD/EDD), BSA, and AML operations across commercial lending portfolios, maintaining zero compliance incidents throughout tenure.
- Directed incident response lifecycles (detection, containment, root-cause investigation, recovery, post-mortems) for critical operational events, substantially reducing Mean Time to Resolution (MTTR).
- Designed phased project roadmaps for major commercial lending servicing platforms under strict US regulatory frameworks (BSA, USA PATRIOT Act, FACTA).
- Modernized underwriting and credit risk decisioning workflows, collaborating with risk, legal, and engineering teams to enhance decisioning speed and accuracy.

Risk & Project Manager | Qihoo Finance India Pvt. Ltd. Sep 2019 – Aug 2020 | Gurgaon, India

- Managed daily operations across KYC, AML, PEP & Sanctions Screening, and Transaction Filtering teams for a high-volume digital consumer lending platform.
- Operationalized Behavioral Analytics for Fraud Detection and anomaly detection rules, driving down fraud rates and unauthorized transactions.

- Streamlined Chargeback Analysis and Dispute Resolution workflows with partner banks, lowering dispute turnaround times and financial losses.

Senior Business & Project Analyst / Lead Credit Analyst | Biz2Credit & American Express Jan 2013 – Jun 2019 | NCR, India

- **Biz2Credit (2019):** Spearheaded KYC Records Refresher programs, AML transaction monitoring, and customer onboarding verification, ensuring 100% regulatory compliance.
- **American Express (2013–2019):** Managed card underwriting, credit decisioning, and dispute management across US, ANZ, and India portfolios for 6+ years; gained deep SME mastery in card issuing/acquiring, ISO 8583 standards, clearing & settlement, and regulatory reporting.

CORE COMPETENCIES & SPECIALIZED SKILLSETS

Project & Delivery:	Agile (Scrum/Kanban), Waterfall, Hybrid SDLC, Program Roadmapping, Backlog Refinement, Sprint Governance, RAID Management, Dependency Mapping, Release & Hypercare Planning, Target Operating Model (TOM).
Product Management:	Product Strategy & Vision, Market Opportunity Assessment, PRD/User Story Authoring, Go-To-Market (GTM) Strategy, User Acceptance Testing (UAT), Feature Prioritization, Competitor Research.
Payments & Core Banking:	UPI, ACH, SWIFT, Cross-Border Payments, Payment Gateways, Core Banking Transformation, ISO 8583, ISO 20022, Card Issuing & Acquiring, Clearing & Settlement, Reconciliation, API Banking.
RegTech, Risk & Compliance:	AML, KYC (CDD/EDD), BSA, PEP & Sanctions Screening, Behavioral Analytics Fraud Monitoring, Chargeback & Dispute Resolution, Commercial Credit Underwriting, Client Onboarding, PCI-DSS.
Tools & Technologies:	Jira, Confluence, MS Project, Smartsheet, Aha! Roadmapping, Power BI (Dashboards/MIS), SQL, Postman (API Testing), Figma, HP ALM, Sauce Labs.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.) in Computer Science RGPV University, Bhopal GPA: 7.8/10.0	Certifications & Badges: Certified Scrum Master (CSM), Product Management, Project Management, Power BI Data Analyst, Jira Administration, Procurement & Vendor Management.
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